

How a Process Engineer turned CISO operationalized OT Cyber Policy

A Manitoba Hydro Case Study in Pragmatic
Cyber Policy in Critical Infrastructure

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Critical Infrastructure: The Stakes are High

- **Critical Energy Responsibility:**

Manitoba Hydro safeguards critical energy infrastructure and sensitive operational technology from cyber threats.

- **Universal Cyber Risk:**

Every employee is a potential target, highlighting the universal risk of cyber attacks on the organization.

- **Collective Cybersecurity Responsibility:**

Protecting infrastructure requires collective responsibility and informed action from all organizational levels.





The Human Link in the Cyber Defense Chain

- People play a key role in strengthening or weakening cybersecurity defenses.
- Clear policies reduce confusion and empower employees and leaders to act with confidence.
- Clarity and accountability create a foundation for resilience—every employee starts strong.

The Governance Gap

- Policies were either too vague or too detailed.
- Roles and responsibilities were unclear.
- Guidance didn't speak to its intended audience.
- Content lacked consistency and completeness.
- The structure didn't reflect how the organization truly operates.
- Siloed focus on IT.



Forging a Stronger Chain: Strategic Enablers

- Creation of a dedicated Cybersecurity Division.
- CISO leadership.
- Executive and C-suite commitment turned intent into action.
- Collaborative, cross functional approach.

Forging a Stronger Chain: Policy Goals

- Ensure clarity, readability, and relevance.
- Support decision-making and accountability.
- Reduce policy burden.
- Fill critical gaps.
- Bring IT and OT together.



The North Star

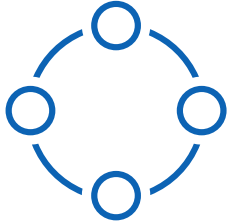
Unified Vision

Strategic Alignment

Accountability &
Transparency

Legal & Regulatory





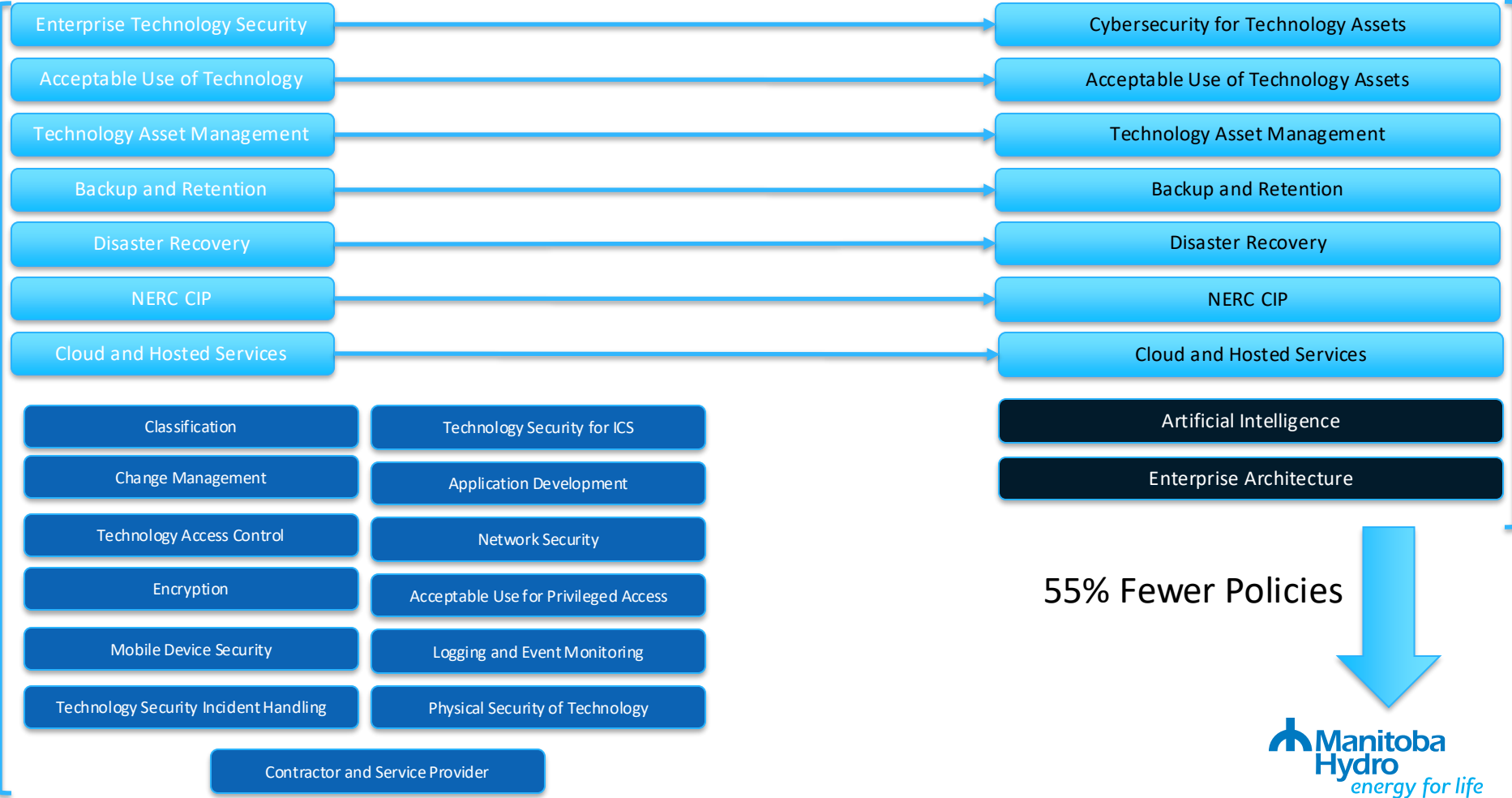
Our Process

- Removed aspirational and procedural language.
- Applied industry best practices.
- Conducted multiple rounds of review and refinement.
- Engaged a technical writer.



Our Outcome

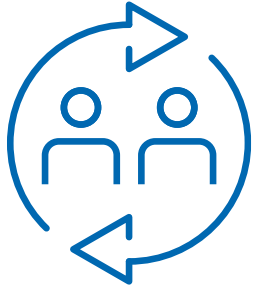
- Started with **20 policies**.
- Retired or consolidated **13 policies**.
- Created **2 new policies**: Artificial Intelligence and Enterprise Architecture.
- Result: 9 corporate policies (**a 55% reduction**).





Continuous Improvement

- Embedded a questions and feedback section within each policy to capture all requests in one place.
- Consolidated feedback for easier tracking and action.
- Quarterly reviews of feedback drive updates and changes to keep policies relevant.



Key Takeaways

- Adopt a unified approach.
- Prioritize governance and clarity.
- Embrace cross-functional collaboration.
- Commit to continuous improvement.

Questions?

